

/cancel

Cancel a background task (/cancel | /cancel help)

Overview

/cancel cancels a running background task by ID prefix. It matches against two registries: the active benchmark task (cancelling it raises the bench cancel flag and asks the benchmark loop to stop cooperatively) and the active sub-agent task list (the matched entry is removed from the list immediately).

A prefix match is used, so a short unique ID prefix is enough - the command finds the first task whose ID starts with the given prefix. /cancel help prints the subcommand table; an empty argument is a usage error.

Syntax

```
/cancel <task_id_prefix>
/cancel help
```

Options / Subcommands

Form	Description
/cancel <task_id_prefix>	Cancel a running background task or benchmark by ID prefix
/cancel help	Show the /cancel help table

Notes:

- Benchmark tasks: when the prefix matches `active_bench_task_id`, the bench cancellation flag is set and the status bar shows a wait marker; the benchmark stops between steps, not mid-step.
- Sub-agent tasks: the first `active_tasks` entry whose ID starts with the prefix is removed from the list.
- Prefix matching is `starts_with` on the raw ID; no case folding.

Examples

```
/cancel a1b2c3
```

```
/cancel bench
```

Cancel a benchmark (status bar):

```
bench: cancellation requested
```

Cancel a sub-agent task (status bar shows first 8 ID chars):

```
Cancelled task a1b2c3d4 (coder)
```

```
/cancel help
```

Missing argument (status bar + warn log):

[warn] Please provide a task ID prefix: /cancel <id>

No match:

No task found with ID starting with 'zz'

Output

- On benchmark cancel: status bar bench: cancellation requested, Info log Benchmark cancellation requested for <prefix>.
- On task cancel: status bar Cancelled task <8-char id> (<agent>), Info log Task cancelled: <8-char id>... (<agent>), and the entry is removed from the active task list.
- On no match: status bar No task found with ID starting with '<prefix>' plus a Warn log entry.
- /cancel help appends an assistant bubble From: /cancel help with the subcommand table; status shows cancel: help.

Related

- /bench - run benchmarks that produce the cancellable bench task
- Background sub-agents are spawned with `new_agent` and listed in the task UI
- /help - list all available slash commands